Which rewrite reads better, and which stays true?

Each item shows an original text and two rewrites of it, X and Y. The rewrites were made by different versions of an editing tool. You are not told which is which, and the order is mixed.

For each item, answer two separate questions. Judge them separately: a rewrite can read beautifully and still change what the writer said.

• **Natural:** Which rewrite reads more like a real person wrote it for this purpose (a blog post, an email, a Slack message, a report, an academic abstract)? Consider rhythm, word choice, and whether it fits its reader. Ignore whether it is faithful.

• **Faithful:** Which rewrite better keeps what the original says? Check facts, numbers, names, how certain the writer is ("may" is not "will", "some" is not "most", a correlation is not a cause), the writer's conclusion, and the writer's feelings. A feeling or opinion the writer never expressed counts as an error.

Answer X, Y, or same. Use "same" only when you honestly cannot choose. Add a short note when something decided it for you.

Write your answers in the response sheet: one row per item, with your name or initials, the packet number on this page, and the item's sample name.

Packet 2 · 23 items

Item 1 · 01-blog-sourdough

Original

> # My Sourdough Journey: Lessons Learned Along The Way
>
> Let's be honest — baking sourdough isn't just a hobby; it's a lesson in patience. When I first embarked on this journey in March 2023, I had no idea what lay ahead.
>
> My first starter? It died after about two weeks. Devastating. But that failure taught me something profound: the starter isn't just flour and water, it's a living ecosystem that demands attention, consistency, and care.
>
> Here's the thing. Switching to a 50/50 blend of whole wheat and white flour was a game-changer. Suddenly, my starter was thriving, bubbling with life and energy.
>
> Today, I bake twice a week, and my 78% hydration dough has become a testament to how far I've come. Every loaf tells a story.
>
> The lesson? Trust the process. Embrace the failures. Celebrate the small wins.
>
> Whether you're a seasoned baker or just starting out, the world of sourdough is waiting for you. Happy baking! ■

What the original says, in short:

• writer started baking sourdough in March 2023

• first starter died after about two weeks

• switched to 50/50 whole wheat and white flour for the starter

• bakes twice a week now

• uses a 78% hydration dough

Rewrite X

> # What sourdough has taught me so far
>
> I started baking sourdough in March 2023 with no idea what I was getting into. Mostly it has taught me patience.
>
> My first starter died after about two weeks, and I took it harder than I'd like to admit. What I hadn't understood is that a starter is alive. It needs feeding on a steady schedule, not whenever I happen to remember it.
>
> Switching to a 50/50 blend of whole wheat and white flour fixed it. After that, my starter bubbled up reliably, and I finally stopped worrying about it.
>
> These days I bake twice a week, with a 78% hydration dough. When I think back to that first dead jar, I'm a little proud of how far I've come.
>
> If you've been meaning to try sourdough, expect to lose a starter or two along the way. Happy baking.

Rewrite Y

> # What sourdough has taught me so far
>
> Baking sourdough has been a lesson in patience. When I started in March 2023, I had no idea what I was in for.
>
> My first starter died after about two weeks, and I took it harder than I'd like to admit. It did teach me that a starter is a living culture, and it needs steady attention.
>
> Switching to a 50/50 blend of whole wheat and white flour changed everything. Almost overnight, the starter was healthy and bubbling.
>
> Now I bake twice a week, and my 78% hydration dough shows me how far I've come.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 2 · `02-blog-remote-work`

Original

> # Navigating The Remote Work Landscape: What We Learned
>
> In today's fast-paced world, remote work has become more than a trend — it's a fundamental shift in how teams operate. When our team of 12 went fully remote in 2021, we embarked on a transformative journey that reshaped our culture, our processes, and our understanding of collaboration.
>
> **Communication:** We moved standups from daily to three times a week, fostering deeper focus while maintaining alignment.
>
> **Decision-Making:** We adopted written proposals for any decision over $5,000, ensuring transparency and accountability.
>
> **Connection:** Twice a year, we gather for an in-person offsite, cultivating the bonds that make our team thrive.
>
> Of course, the journey wasn't without challenges. One engineer left, citing isolation — a stark reminder that remote work isn't for everyone.
>
> Ultimately, remote work isn't about where you work. It's about how you work. And for us, that has made all the difference.

What the original says, in short:

• team of 12 went fully remote in 2021
• moved standups from daily to three times a week
• adopted written proposals for decisions over $5,000
• one engineer quit citing isolation
• they hold an in-person offsite twice a year

Rewrite X

> # What we learned going remote
>
> Our team of 12 went fully remote in 2021, and we had to change more of our habits than I expected.
>
> We cut standups from daily to three times a week. People get longer stretches of focus, and we still stay in sync.
>
> Any decision over $5,000 now needs a written proposal, so everyone can see what was decided and who signed off on it.
>
> Twice a year we meet in person for an offsite. That's where a lot of the team's closeness comes from.
>
> It hasn't worked for everyone. One engineer left, citing isolation, and that one still bothers me. For the rest of us, these changes are what made remote work hold together.

Rewrite Y

> # What we learned from going remote
>
> When our team of 12 went fully remote in 2021, it changed our culture, our processes, and how we collaborate.
>
> We cut standups from daily to three times a week, which gave people more time to focus while keeping everyone in sync. Any decision over $5,000 now needs a written proposal, so the reasoning is out in the open and someone owns it. And twice a year we meet in person for an offsite to keep the team close.
>
> It wasn't all smooth. One engineer left, citing isolation, which reminded us that remote work doesn't suit everyone.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 3 · `03-blog-product-launch`

Original

> # Introducing Ledgerly 2.0: Invoicing, Reimagined ■
>
> We're thrilled to announce Ledgerly 2.0 — a groundbreaking update that redefines how freelancers manage their finances.
>
> Freelancers juggle countless responsibilities. That's why we built Ledgerly 2.0 to seamlessly streamline your workflow, empower your business, and unlock new possibilities.
>
> **What's New:**
>
> - **Recurring Invoices:** Set it and forget it. Ledgerly handles the rest.
>
> - **Multi-Currency Support:** Bill clients in 24 currencies, empowering you to work globally without friction.
>
> And the best part? Pricing stays at just $9 per month. No hidden fees. No surprises. Just value.
>
> Ledgerly 2.0 is available starting June 3. This isn't just an update — it's a commitment to the freelancers who power the modern economy.
>
> The future of invoicing is here. Are you ready?

What the original says, in short:

• product is Ledgerly, an invoicing app for freelancers
• version 2.0 adds recurring invoices and multi-currency support
• supports 24 currencies
• price stays at $9 per month
• available from June 3

Rewrite X

> # Ledgerly 2.0: invoicing, reimagined
>
> Ledgerly 2.0 is available June 3, with changes to how freelancers manage their finances.
>
> Freelancers have a lot to juggle, so we built this release to make the business side simpler. It adds two things.
>
> Recurring invoices: set one up once and Ledgerly handles the rest.
>
> Multi-currency support: bill clients in 24 currencies, so you can work with clients around the world.
>
> The price stays at $9 a month, with no hidden fees.

Rewrite Y

> # Introducing Ledgerly 2.0

We're excited to announce Ledgerly 2.0, the next version of our invoicing tool for freelancers, who already have plenty to keep track of.

Two things are new:

- Recurring invoices. Set one up once and Ledgerly handles the rest.

- Multi-currency support. You can bill clients in 24 currencies, which makes working with clients abroad much simpler.

Pricing stays at $9 a month, with no hidden fees.

Ledgerly 2.0 is available starting June 3.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 4 · `04-email-deadline`

Original

> Subject: Request to Reschedule Design Review
>
> Hi Priya,
>
> I hope this email finds you well! I wanted to reach out regarding the design review currently scheduled for Thursday.
>
> Due to the fact that the vendor delivered the mockups two days later than anticipated, I believe it would be beneficial to move the review to Monday at 2pm. This adjustment would ensure that the team has adequate time to thoroughly evaluate the materials, fostering a more productive and meaningful discussion.
>
> I completely understand that schedules are busy, and I truly appreciate your flexibility and understanding in this matter. Your support is invaluable to the success of this project.
>
> Please don't hesitate to let me know if Monday at 2pm works for you, or if there's another time that would better align with your availability.
>
> Thank you so much for your time and consideration!
>
> Best regards,
>
> Daniel

What the original says, in short:

• writer is asking Priya to move the design review

• review currently set for Thursday

• proposed new time is Monday at 2pm

• reason is the vendor delivered the mockups two days late

Rewrite X

> Subject: Moving the design review to Monday
>
> Hi Priya,
>
> Could we move Thursday's design review to Monday at 2pm? The vendor delivered the mockups two days late, and I'd like the team to have time to go through them properly before we meet.
>
> I know everyone's schedule is full, so thanks for being flexible. If Monday at 2pm doesn't work for you, let me know a time that does.
>
> Thanks,
>
> Daniel

Rewrite Y

Subject: Moving the design review to Monday

Hi Priya,

Could we move Thursday's design review to Monday at 2pm? The vendor delivered the mockups two days late, and the extra time would let the team go through them properly so the discussion is more useful.

I know schedules are busy, and I appreciate the flexibility. If Monday at 2pm doesn't work for you, let me know a time that does.

Thanks for your time.

Best regards,

Daniel

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 5 · `05-email-followup`

Original

> Subject: Following Up on Our Conversation
>
> Dear Marcus,
>
> Thank you so much for taking the time to speak with me last Tuesday. It was truly a pleasure to learn more about your operations and the exciting challenges your team is navigating.
>
> As discussed, I will send over the pricing sheet by Friday. Additionally, I wanted to circle back on your question regarding SAP integration. Great question! Our platform does indeed integrate with SAP, though it's worth noting that this requires a paid connector.
>
> I'm confident that a pilot with 3 warehouses would serve as an excellent starting point, allowing your team to experience firsthand the transformative impact our solution can deliver — from improved visibility to streamlined operations to enhanced decision-making.
>
> I look forward to the opportunity to continue this conversation and explore how we can support your goals. Should you have any questions in the meantime, please do not hesitate to reach out.
>
> Warm regards,
>
> Elena

What the original says, in short:

- follow-up after a call with Marcus last Tuesday
- writer will send the pricing sheet by Friday
- pilot would run with 3 warehouses
- Marcus asked about SAP integration; it exists but needs a paid connector

Rewrite X

> Subject: Following up on our conversation
>
> Dear Marcus,
>
> Thanks for taking the time to talk with me last Tuesday. I enjoyed hearing about your operations and the problems your team is working through.
>
> As we discussed, I'll send over the pricing sheet by Friday.
>
> On your SAP question: yes, our platform integrates with SAP, but it needs a paid connector.
>
> I'd suggest starting with a pilot at 3 warehouses. That would let your team see for themselves whether it improves visibility and day-to-day operations.
>
> I'd like to keep talking about where we could help. If you have any questions in the meantime, just reach out.
>
> Warm regards,

Elena

Rewrite Y

Subject: Following up on our conversation

Dear Marcus,

Thank you for speaking with me last Tuesday. It was a pleasure to learn more about your operations and the challenges your team is working through.

As we discussed, I'll send the pricing sheet by Friday. On your SAP question: yes, our platform integrates with SAP, though it needs a paid connector.

I think a pilot with 3 warehouses would be a good place to start. Your team could see firsthand what the platform does for visibility, day-to-day operations, and decision-making.

I look forward to continuing the conversation. If you have any questions before then, please get in touch.

Warm regards,

Elena

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 6 · `06-email-decline`

Original

> Subject: Re: Speaking Invitation
>
> Hi Jordan,
>
> Thank you so much for thinking of me for the October conference! I'm truly honored by the invitation, and it means a great deal that you'd consider me for this opportunity.
>
> Unfortunately, after careful consideration, I won't be able to participate this year. We have a major product launch scheduled for the same week, and I need to remain fully focused on ensuring its success.
>
> That said, I'd love to recommend my colleague Wen Li. Wen led our migration project and brings a wealth of knowledge, a unique perspective, and an engaging presentation style that I'm confident would resonate with your audience.
>
> I would absolutely welcome the chance to be considered for next year's event. Wishing you and the team all the best as you put together what I'm sure will be an incredible lineup!
>
> Warmly,
>
> Sam

What the original says, in short:

• writer is declining to speak at the October conference

• reason is a product launch the same week

• suggests colleague Wen Li, who led the migration project

• open to speaking next year

Rewrite X

> Subject: Re: Speaking Invitation
>
> Hi Jordan,
>
> Thank you for thinking of me for the October conference. I'm honored to be asked.
>
> Unfortunately, I won't be able to speak this year. We have a major product launch the same week, and I need to stay focused on it.
>
> I'd like to recommend my colleague Wen Li instead. Wen led our migration project, knows the subject deeply, and is an engaging presenter. I think your audience would respond well.
>
> I'd be glad to be considered for next year's event. All the best to you and the team as you put the lineup together.
>
> Warmly,
>
> Sam

Rewrite Y

Subject: Re: Speaking invitation

Hi Jordan,

Thanks for thinking of me for the October conference. Unfortunately, I can't do it this year. We have a major product launch the same week, and I need to stay focused on it.

I'd like to recommend my colleague Wen Li instead. Wen led our migration project, knows the material well, and is an engaging speaker. I think your audience would get a lot out of the talk.

I'd be glad to be considered for next year's event. Good luck putting this year's lineup together.

Warmly,

Sam

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 7 · `07-tech-readme`

Original

> # QuickCache ■
>
> QuickCache is a powerful, lightweight, and intuitive Python library that seamlessly caches function results — empowering developers to build faster applications with minimal effort.
>
> ## Key Features
>
> - **Simple:** Just add a decorator. No configuration file needed.
>
> - **Persistent:** Results are stored on disk in `~/.quickcache`, ensuring your cache survives restarts.
>
> - **Flexible:** The default TTL of 3600 seconds can be easily customized to suit your needs.
>
> ## How It Works
>
> At its core, QuickCache leverages a robust key-generation strategy. Keys are built from the function name and arguments, ensuring that each unique call is cached independently.
>
> ## Installation
>
> `bash
>
> pip install quickcache
>
> `
>
> ## Limitations
>
> It's worth noting that QuickCache does not currently support async functions. We're actively exploring this feature and look forward to delivering it in a future release!
>
> Happy caching! ■

What the original says, in short:

• tool is quickcache, a Python decorator for caching function results
• stores results on disk in ~/.quickcache
• default TTL is 3600 seconds
• install with pip install quickcache
• keys are built from the function name and arguments
• does not support async functions yet

Rewrite X

> # QuickCache
>
> QuickCache is a lightweight Python library that caches function results.
>
> ## Features

Add a decorator to a function and QuickCache caches its results. You don't need a configuration file.

Results are stored on disk in `~/.quickcache`, so the cache survives restarts.

The default TTL is 3600 seconds, and you can change it.

How it works

QuickCache builds each cache key from the function name and its arguments, so each unique call is cached separately.

Installation

`bash

pip install quickcache

`

Limitations

QuickCache does not support async functions yet. We're looking into adding support in a future release.

Rewrite Y

QuickCache

QuickCache is a lightweight Python library that caches function results.

Features

- To cache a function, add a decorator. You don't need a configuration file.
- Results are stored on disk in `~/.quickcache`, so the cache survives restarts.
- The default TTL is 3600 seconds, and you can change it.

How it works

QuickCache builds each cache key from the function name and its arguments, so each unique call is cached separately.

Installation

`bash

pip install quickcache

`

Limitations

QuickCache does not support async functions yet. We're looking into adding support in a future release.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 8 · `08-tech-postmortem`

Original

> ## Incident Summary
>
> On March 14, our platform experienced a 47-minute outage that significantly impacted the customer experience. This incident serves as a crucial reminder of the importance of robust monitoring practices.
>
> ## Root Cause
>
> The root cause was an expired TLS certificate on the internal API gateway. It's important to note that the certificate renewal job had been silently failing since February — a failure that went undetected. This wasn't just a technical oversight; it was a gap in our observability.
>
> ## Impact
>
> Approximately 30% of checkout requests failed during the incident window, underscoring the critical role that the API gateway plays in our infrastructure.
>
> ## Remediation
>
> Moving forward, we have implemented alerting for certificates expiring within 14 days, ensuring that similar incidents are proactively identified and addressed. This represents a significant step toward building a more resilient, reliable, and robust system.
>
> ## Lessons Learned
>
> Ultimately, this incident highlights a fundamental truth: what you don't monitor, you can't fix.

What the original says, in short:

- outage on March 14 lasted 47 minutes
- caused by an expired TLS certificate on the internal API gateway
- about 30% of checkout requests failed
- certificate renewal job had been silently failing since February
- fix: added alerting for certificates expiring within 14 days

Rewrite X

> ## Incident summary
>
> On March 14, our platform had a 47-minute outage that affected customers.
>
> ## Root cause
>
> The TLS certificate on the internal API gateway expired. The certificate renewal job had been failing silently since February, and nothing alerted us to it.
>
> ## Impact
>
> About 30% of checkout requests failed during the outage.

Remediation

We now alert on any certificate that expires within 14 days.

Lessons learned

We weren't monitoring the renewal job, so its failure went unnoticed until the certificate expired and took down checkout.

Rewrite Y

Incident summary

On March 14, the platform had a 47-minute outage that significantly affected customers.

Root cause

The TLS certificate on the internal API gateway expired. The certificate renewal job had been failing silently since February, and our monitoring did not detect it.

Impact

About 30% of checkout requests failed during the outage.

Remediation

We added alerts for certificates that expire within 14 days.

Lessons learned

We can't fix failures we aren't monitoring for.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 9 · `09-tech-pr-description`

Original

> ## Summary
>
> This PR introduces a transformative improvement to the order-sync service by replacing the legacy polling loop with a modern webhook handler. This change not only enhances efficiency but also lays the groundwork for a more scalable architecture.
>
> ## Key Changes
>
> - ■ **Webhook Handler:** Replaces the polling loop, reducing API calls to the vendor from ~40,000/day to ~1,200/day — a dramatic improvement!
>
> - ■ **Security:** Webhook signatures are verified using HMAC-SHA256, ensuring the integrity and authenticity of incoming events.
>
> - ■ **Feature Flag:** The legacy polling code remains available behind the `order_sync_polling` flag for one release, providing a seamless fallback.
>
> - ■ **Testing:** Comprehensive tests have been added for signature failures and duplicate events.
>
> ## Why This Matters
>
> In today's event-driven landscape, polling is no longer sufficient. This change aligns our architecture with industry best practices and positions us for future growth.
>
> Let me know if you have any questions or feedback! ■

What the original says, in short:

• PR replaces the polling loop in order-sync with a webhook handler

• reduces API calls to the vendor from about 40,000 a day to about 1,200

• webhook signatures are verified with HMAC-SHA256

• old polling code stays behind a feature flag named order_sync_polling for one release

• tests added for signature failure and duplicate events

Rewrite X

> ## Summary
>
> This PR replaces the polling loop in the order-sync service with a webhook handler.
>
> ## Changes
>
> - The webhook handler replaces the polling loop and cuts API calls to the vendor from ~40,000/day to ~1,200/day.
>
> - Webhook signatures are verified with HMAC-SHA256.
>
> - The legacy polling code stays available behind the `order_sync_polling` flag for one release, as a fallback.
>
> - Added tests for signature failures and duplicate events.

Rewrite Y

> ## Summary
>
> Replaces the polling loop in the order-sync service with a webhook handler. This cuts vendor API calls sharply and lays groundwork for a more scalable design.
>
> ## Changes
>
> - The webhook handler replaces the polling loop and reduces API calls to the vendor from ~40,000/day to ~1,200/day.
> - Webhook signatures are verified with HMAC-SHA256.
> - The legacy polling code stays available behind the `order_sync_polling` flag for one release as a fallback.
> - Added tests for signature failures and duplicate events.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 10 · `10-essay-cities`

Original

> In the ever-evolving tapestry of urban planning, few policies have proven as quietly consequential as parking minimums. These regulations, often overlooked, play a pivotal role in shaping the very fabric of our cities.
>
> Parking minimums aren't just about cars — they're about housing, affordability, and the kind of communities we choose to build. By requiring developers to include parking, these rules raise the cost of new housing, effectively pricing out the very residents cities claim to serve.
>
> Consider Minneapolis. In 2021, the city eliminated parking minimums citywide, marking a bold step toward a more equitable future. This decision stands as a testament to what's possible when cities prioritize people over pavement.
>
> To be clear, I'm not saying parking doesn't matter. Some neighborhoods do face genuine shortages. But the question isn't whether we need parking. The real question is: who should decide how much?
>
> Ultimately, the answer is clear. Cities must embrace change. The future of urban living depends on it.

What the original says, in short:

• argument that cities should remove parking minimums

• Minneapolis eliminated parking minimums citywide in 2021

• parking minimums raise the cost of new housing

• essay grants that some neighborhoods have real parking shortages

Rewrite X

> Few urban planning policies have done as much, with as little attention, as parking minimums. These rules shape a large part of how our cities look and work.
>
> They seem like a rule about cars, but they are also about housing, what it costs, and what kind of communities we build. Requiring developers to include parking raises the cost of new housing, and that effectively prices out the residents cities say they want to serve.
>
> Consider Minneapolis. In 2021, the city eliminated parking minimums citywide. It was a bold move toward a more equitable city, and it shows what's possible when a city puts people ahead of pavement.
>
> Parking still matters, and some neighborhoods do have real shortages. The question is who should decide how much.

Rewrite Y

> Parking minimums get little attention in urban planning, but they shape a lot of what our cities look like.

The rules are about housing and affordability as much as cars, and about the kind of communities we choose to build. When developers have to include parking, new housing costs more, and that cost can price out the residents cities say they want to serve.

Minneapolis eliminated parking minimums citywide in 2021. I think it was a bold move, and a good example of what a city can do when it puts people ahead of pavement.

Parking still matters, and some neighborhoods do have real shortages. What I want to know is who should decide how much parking gets built.

My answer is that cities need to be willing to change these rules.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 11 · `11-essay-reading`

Original

> Reading is more than a hobby — it's a window into other worlds, a mirror reflecting our own, and a bridge connecting us to ideas across time and space.
>
> Last year, I read 52 books. I tracked every single one in a meticulously organized spreadsheet. Title. Author. Date. Rating. It was efficient. It was satisfying. It was hollow.
>
> This year, I stopped tracking. The result? I've read 19 books so far — and I'm enjoying every page more than ever. Without the pressure of numbers, reading has become a journey rather than a destination.
>
> Does that mean tracking is bad? Not at all. It simply means that the metrics we use can subtly reshape the experiences we value. When we measure something, we change it.
>
> And yet — I'll admit it — I still miss the spreadsheet a little. There's something comforting about seeing progress laid out in neat rows.
>
> In the end, perhaps the real lesson is this: reading isn't about the numbers. It's about the stories that stay with us long after the final page.

What the original says, in short:

• writer read 52 books last year by tracking them in a spreadsheet

• this year stopped tracking and has read 19 books so far

• writer enjoys reading more now

• writer admits they still miss the spreadsheet a little

Rewrite X

> Last year I read 52 books and logged every one in a carefully organized spreadsheet: title, author, date, rating. It was efficient, and keeping it up felt satisfying, but by the end the whole thing felt hollow.
>
> This year I stopped tracking. I've read 19 books so far, and I'm enjoying them more than I ever did. Without a number to hit, I read for the book instead of the count.
>
> I don't think tracking is bad. I do think the things we measure can change how we experience them, in ways that are easy to miss.
>
> Still, I'll admit I miss the spreadsheet a little. There was something comforting about seeing my progress laid out in neat rows.

Rewrite Y

> Last year I read 52 books and logged every one in a carefully organized spreadsheet: title, author, date, rating. It was efficient and satisfying, and it felt hollow.
>
> This year I stopped tracking. I've read 19 books so far, and I'm enjoying every page more than I ever have. Without a number to hit, reading feels less like heading for a finish line.

That doesn't make tracking bad. The metrics we use can subtly reshape the experiences we value, because measuring something changes it.

Still, I'll admit I miss the spreadsheet a little. There's something comforting about seeing progress laid out in neat rows.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 12 · `12-essay-ai-art`

Original

> The rise of AI-generated art represents one of the most profound shifts in the creative landscape of our time. As a working illustrator, I find myself navigating a complex and multifaceted reality — one filled with both promise and peril.
>
> In 2024, I lost two clients to image generators. This experience was not merely a professional setback; it was a deeply personal reckoning with the evolving value of human creativity.
>
> Yet the story is more nuanced than it might first appear. I still use AI tools for reference gathering, leveraging their capabilities to enhance my workflow. This duality — resisting and embracing at the same time — encapsulates the intricate interplay between artist and machine.
>
> At the heart of the matter lies a fundamental question of consent. The training-data consent problem remains unresolved, casting a long shadow over the industry's future.
>
> Moving forward, artists, technologists, and policymakers must work together to forge a path that honors creativity, fosters innovation, and ensures fairness. Only then can we unlock the full potential of this transformative technology.

What the original says, in short:

- writer is a working illustrator
- lost two clients in 2024 to image generators
- still uses AI tools for reference gathering
- thinks the training-data consent problem is unresolved

Rewrite X

> AI-generated art is one of the biggest changes to creative work in my lifetime. I'm a working illustrator, and from where I sit it brings real promise and real danger at once.
>
> In 2024 I lost two clients to image generators. It was a professional setback, but it also hit me personally, and it made me ask what human creativity is worth now.
>
> The story is more complicated than that, though. I still use AI tools to gather reference material, and they make parts of my workflow better. So I resist these tools and use them at the same time.
>
> The central question for me is consent. Nobody has resolved whether the artists whose work trained these models agreed to it, and that problem hangs over the industry's future.
>
> Artists, technologists, and policymakers will have to work this out together, in a way that is fair to the people whose creativity these systems are built on and still leaves room for new tools.

Rewrite Y

> I'm a working illustrator, and AI-generated art is the biggest change my field has seen in a long time. Some of it looks promising to me, and some of it scares me.

In 2024 I lost two clients to image generators. That hurt my business, and it hurt more personally than I expected, because it made me ask how much people still value what a human illustrator does.

I still use AI tools to gather reference, though, and they do make that part of my work faster. So I'm resisting these tools and using them at the same time, and I haven't settled how I feel about that.

What I keep coming back to is consent. Nobody has resolved whether the work these models were trained on was used with permission, and until that's settled it hangs over everything else in the industry.

Artists, technologists, and policymakers will have to work this out together, and whatever they agree on has to be fair to the people who make the art.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 13 · `13-slack-flaky-test`

This is a reply to: #backend thread. Aisha: "test_checkout_total has failed 4 times this week on CI, anyone know why? I already checked it's not the DB fixture."

Original

> Great question, Aisha! I took a deep dive into this one.
>
> So here's what's happening: test_checkout_total has been failing intermittently on CI — 4 times this week, as you mentioned. You're absolutely right that it's not the DB fixture. After careful investigation, I discovered that the root cause is that the test depends on the system clock, which means it fails when it runs near midnight UTC.
>
> This is a classic example of a time-dependent test — a subtle but important class of bugs that can be tricky to catch.
>
> The fix is straightforward: I'll pin the clock using freezegun, ensuring consistent and deterministic behavior across all environments. I'll have a PR up today.
>
> Hope this helps! Let me know if you have any questions. ■

What the original says, in short:

• the test depends on the system clock and fails near midnight UTC

• writer will pin the clock with freezegun

• PR will be up today

Rewrite X

> It depends on the system clock, so it fails when it runs near midnight UTC. I'll pin the clock with freezegun and have a PR up today.

Rewrite Y

> It's the system clock. test_checkout_total depends on it, so it fails when it runs near midnight UTC. I'll pin the clock with freezegun and have a PR up today.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 14 · `14-slack-meeting`

This is a reply to: DM from manager Tom: "can you make the 3pm planning sync tomorrow? need you there for the Q3 roadmap bit"

Original

> Hi Tom! Thanks for reaching out and including me in the planning sync.
>
> Unfortunately, I have a dentist appointment at 3pm tomorrow that I'm unable to reschedule. That said, I want to make sure I can still contribute meaningfully to the Q3 roadmap discussion, as I know how important it is for our team's success.
>
> I'll be able to join from 3:30 onward. In the meantime, I've already left written comments on the Q3 roadmap doc, so my thoughts and perspectives will be captured even before I arrive.
>
> I really appreciate your understanding! Please let me know if there's anything else I can do to help prepare. ■

What the original says, in short:

• writer has a dentist appointment at 3pm tomorrow

• can join from 3:30

• has sent written comments on the Q3 roadmap doc

Rewrite X

> Hi Tom, I've got a dentist appointment at 3 tomorrow that I can't move, but I can join from 3:30. I've already left comments on the Q3 roadmap doc, so you'll have my input before I get there. Thanks for understanding!

Rewrite Y

> Hi Tom, thanks for including me. I have a dentist appointment at 3pm tomorrow that I can't reschedule, but I can join from 3:30. I've already left written comments on the Q3 roadmap doc, so you'll have my input before I get there.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 15 · `15-slack-review`

This is a reply to: PR review thread. Reviewer Ken: "Why not just bump the timeout to 60s instead of adding a retry? Seems simpler."

Original

> That's a great point, Ken, and I really appreciate you raising it! Simplicity is definitely something we should always strive for.
>
> However, it's important to note that the issue isn't just about slow responses — it's about dropped connections. The upstream service sometimes drops connections entirely, which means a longer timeout wouldn't actually help in those cases. The request would simply hang until it hit the 60s limit and then fail anyway.
>
> The retry approach, on the other hand, uses 3 attempts with exponential backoff, ensuring that transient failures are handled gracefully and robustly.
>
> That said, I completely understand the concern about added complexity. I'm more than happy to add a comment in the code explaining the reasoning, so future readers have the full context.
>
> Let me know if that works for you!

What the original says, in short:

• the upstream service sometimes drops connections, not just slow responses

• a longer timeout would not help with dropped connections

• retry uses 3 attempts with exponential backoff

• writer is fine adding a comment in the code explaining this

Rewrite X

> Good question, Ken. The upstream service sometimes drops the connection entirely, and a longer timeout doesn't help there: the request just hangs until it hits 60s and fails anyway. The retry makes 3 attempts with exponential backoff, which covers those dropped connections.
>
> Fair point on the added complexity, though. I'll add a comment in the code explaining why it's a retry. Does that work for you?

Rewrite Y

> Good question. The problem is dropped connections as well as slow responses. The upstream service sometimes drops a connection entirely, and a longer timeout doesn't help there: the request just hangs until it hits 60s and then fails anyway. The retry makes 3 attempts with exponential backoff, which handles those transient failures.
>
> I get the concern about added complexity. Happy to add a comment in the code explaining the reasoning so future readers have the context.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 16 · `16-academic-abstract`

Original

> Sleep plays a pivotal role in memory consolidation, yet its impact on academic performance remains underexplored. The present study conducts a comprehensive investigation into the relationship between sleep duration and memory performance among undergraduate students, leveraging wrist actigraphy to provide objective measurement of sleep across 14 nights. Drawing on a sample of 84 undergraduates, the findings demonstrate a significant positive correlation between sleep duration and next-day word-list recall (r = 0.31), highlighting the critical importance of adequate rest for cognitive functioning. Interestingly, no effect was observed for reaction time. Moreover, these results provide compelling evidence that sleep optimization represents a powerful intervention for enhancing student achievement. Furthermore, the study makes a significant contribution to the growing body of literature on sleep and cognition, paving the way for evidence-based policies in higher education.

What the original says, in short:

• study of 84 undergraduate students

• sleep measured with wrist actigraphy over 14 nights

• correlation between sleep duration and next-day word-list recall was r = 0.31

• design is correlational

• no effect of sleep duration on reaction time

Rewrite X

> Sleep supports memory consolidation, but its effect on academic performance has received little study. We examined the relationship between sleep duration and memory performance in 84 undergraduate students, measuring sleep objectively with wrist actigraphy across 14 nights. Sleep duration correlated significantly and positively with next-day word-list recall (r = 0.31). We found no effect on reaction time. Because the results are correlational, they suggest that adequate sleep may support students' memory, but they do not show that improving sleep would raise achievement. The study adds to research on sleep and cognition and may help inform policy in higher education.

Rewrite Y

> Sleep supports memory consolidation, but its effect on academic performance has received little study. We examined the relationship between sleep duration and memory performance in 84 undergraduates, using wrist actigraphy to measure sleep objectively over 14 nights. Sleep duration correlated positively with next-day word-list recall (r = 0.31), and the correlation was significant. We found no effect on reaction time. These results suggest that adequate sleep may matter for students' cognitive functioning, although a correlational design cannot show that improving sleep would raise achievement. The study adds to research on sleep and cognition and may inform policy in higher education.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 17 · 17-academic-discussion

Original

> ## Limitations and Future Directions
>
> While this study offers valuable insights into the relationship between workload and burnout, it is important to acknowledge certain limitations. The utilization of a sample drawn from a single university may limit the generalizability of the findings, though the observed patterns are likely reflective of broader trends in higher education. The reliance on self-reported workload, collected through a weekly survey, introduces the possibility of reporting bias; nevertheless, the consistency of the responses underscores their reliability. Additionally, the cross-sectional nature of the design precludes causal inference.
>
> Despite these limitations, the association between workload and burnout (beta = 0.12) provides robust support for the importance of workload management. Notably, the findings underscore the need for institutional interventions. Future research should build upon these findings by conducting a longitudinal follow-up, thereby offering a more nuanced understanding of the temporal dynamics underlying burnout and paving the way for targeted, effective, and sustainable solutions.

What the original says, in short:

- participants came from a single university
- workload was self-reported in a weekly survey
- design was cross-sectional
- association between workload and burnout was small (beta = 0.12)
- authors propose a longitudinal follow-up

Rewrite X

> ## Limitations and future directions
>
> This study has several limitations. We drew the sample from a single university, which may limit how far the findings generalize, although the patterns may reflect broader trends in higher education. Workload was self-reported in a weekly survey, so reporting bias is possible. The responses were consistent, which gives some support for their reliability. Because the design was cross-sectional, we cannot infer causation.
>
> Within these limits, the association between workload and burnout (beta = 0.12) supports attention to workload management and suggests that institutional interventions may be needed. A longitudinal follow-up could show how burnout develops over time and help researchers design targeted solutions.

Rewrite Y

> ## Limitations and future directions
>
> This study has several limitations. All participants came from a single university, so the findings may not generalize to other institutions, although similar patterns may hold elsewhere in higher education. Workload was self-reported through a weekly survey, which leaves room for reporting

bias; the responses were consistent, which offers some reassurance about their reliability. The design was also cross-sectional, so it cannot establish cause.

Workload was associated with burnout (beta = 0.12). This fits the view that workload management matters and that institutions may need to intervene, but the cross-sectional design means the association does not show that reducing workload would reduce burnout. A longitudinal follow-up could show how burnout develops over time and help identify interventions that work.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 18 · 18-academic-litreview

Original

> The landscape of remote work research has evolved dramatically in recent years, reflecting the profound transformation of the modern workplace. Numerous studies have shown that remote work leads to improvements in employee well-being (Smith & Zhang, 2021). In a seminal randomized experiment at a Chinese travel agency, Bloom et al. (2015) found a 13% increase in performance among employees working from home, underscoring the transformative potential of flexible arrangements. Conversely, Gibbs et al. (2023) documented a decline in productivity at an Indian IT services company following the transition to working from home, highlighting the intricate interplay between context and outcomes. Taken together, these studies paint a complex and multifaceted picture, emphasizing the need for further investigation into the conditions under which remote work fosters or hinders productivity. Ultimately, the evidence makes clear that remote work is neither a panacea nor a pitfall, but rather a nuanced phenomenon requiring careful consideration.

What the original says, in short:

• Bloom et al. (2015) ran a randomized experiment at a Chinese travel agency and found a 13% performance increase for home workers

• Gibbs et al. (2023) found productivity fell at an Indian IT services company after the shift to working from home

• the paragraph cites Smith and Zhang (2021) for a claim that numerous studies show remote work improves well-being

• the evidence on remote work productivity is mixed

Rewrite X

> Research on remote work has grown quickly in recent years as workplaces have changed. Numerous studies have shown that remote work improves employee well-being (Smith & Zhang, 2021). In a randomized experiment at a Chinese travel agency, Bloom et al. (2015) found a 13% increase in performance among employees working from home. Gibbs et al. (2023), by contrast, documented a decline in productivity at an Indian IT services company after the move to working from home. Together these studies suggest that the outcome depends on context, and more work is needed on the conditions under which remote work helps or hinders productivity. On current evidence, remote work is neither uniformly beneficial nor uniformly harmful.

Rewrite Y

> Research on remote work has grown quickly in recent years as workplaces have changed. Numerous studies have found that remote work improves employee well-being (Smith & Zhang, 2021). In a randomized experiment at a Chinese travel agency, Bloom et al. (2015) found a 13% increase in performance among employees working from home. Gibbs et al. (2023), by contrast, documented a decline in productivity at an Indian IT services company after the transition to working from home. These results suggest that the effect of remote work on productivity depends on context, and further research is needed on the conditions under which it helps or hinders productivity.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 19 · `19-report-quarterly`

Original

> ## Q2 Support Overview
>
> In Q2, support tickets increased by 10%, underscoring the critical importance of proactive customer experience management. Notably, some customers reported slower load times following the March release — a development that warrants careful attention.
>
> One possible explanation is the new image pipeline, although this has not yet been confirmed. Should the issue persist, churn may rise, potentially impacting our growth trajectory.
>
> Regional performance paints a nuanced picture: in Brazil, response times doubled, while elsewhere they remained flat. Moving forward, a comprehensive, data-driven, and customer-centric approach will be essential to navigating these challenges.

What the original says, in short:

- support tickets increased by 10% in Q2
- some customers reported slower load times after the March release
- one possible explanation is the new image pipeline, not confirmed
- churn may rise if the issue persists
- in Brazil response times doubled; elsewhere they were flat

Rewrite X

> ## Q2 support overview
>
> Support tickets rose 10% in Q2. Some customers reported slower load times after the March release. The new image pipeline may be the cause, but we haven't confirmed that yet. If the problem continues, churn may rise and slow our growth.
>
> Response times doubled in Brazil and stayed flat in the other regions.

Rewrite Y

> ## Q2 support overview
>
> Support tickets increased by 10% in Q2. Some customers reported slower load times after the March release. One possible explanation is the new image pipeline, but this has not been confirmed. If the issue persists, churn may rise, which could affect growth.
>
> Response times doubled in Brazil and stayed flat in other regions.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 20 · `20-reflective-neutral`

Original

> Reflecting on this transformative group project has been a profound learning journey. Over six weeks, our five-person team navigated the intricate landscape of collaborative research, with my role centering on the literature review.
>
> Notably, we missed the first draft deadline by two days, a pivotal moment that underscored the importance of effective communication. After week two, we transitioned from email to a shared document, fostering seamless collaboration and enhanced alignment.
>
> Ultimately, our final report received a B+. This experience stands as a testament to the power of teamwork, adaptability, and continuous growth.

What the original says, in short:

• five-person group project over six weeks

• writer was responsible for the literature review

• the group missed the first draft deadline by two days

• the group switched from email to a shared document after week two

• final report received a B+

Rewrite X

> I learned a lot from this group project. There were five of us, it ran for six weeks, and my part was the literature review.
>
> We missed the first draft deadline by two days, and that was when I started taking communication seriously. After week two we moved from email to a shared document, which made it much easier to stay on the same page.
>
> Our final report got a B+. What I took away from it was mostly about working in a team and adjusting when plans slip.

Rewrite Y

> Our group project ran for six weeks with a five-person team, and my part was the literature review.
>
> We missed the first draft deadline by two days, which showed us we needed to communicate better. After week two we moved from email to a shared document, and that made it easier to work together and stay on the same page.
>
> Our final report got a B+.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 21 · `21-slack-uncertain`

Original

> Hey team! ■ Quick update on the deploy: it's looking like it might slip to Thursday. I think the migration is the main blocker here, but I'm not 100% sure yet — still digging in. Currently, about 3 of our 40 integration tests are failing. I'll circle back with a comprehensive update by 4pm. Thanks so much for your patience and understanding! ■

What the original says, in short:

• the deploy might slip to Thursday

• writer thinks the migration is the blocker but is not sure yet

• about 3 of 40 integration tests are failing

• writer will post an update by 4pm

Rewrite X

> Hey team, the deploy might slip to Thursday. I think the migration is the main blocker, but I'm not sure yet and I'm still looking into it. Right now about 3 of our 40 integration tests are failing. I'll post a fuller update by 4pm. Thanks for your patience!

Rewrite Y

> Hey team, the deploy might slip to Thursday. I think the migration is the main blocker, but I'm not sure yet and I'm still digging. Right now about 3 of our 40 integration tests are failing. I'll post a fuller update by 4pm. Thanks for your patience!

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 22 · 22-essay-example

Original

> In the ever-evolving tapestry of local retail, few stories resonate as deeply as that of the corner bookstore in my neighborhood. It closed eight months after a chain store opened just two blocks away.
>
> To be clear, this is just one example, and I don't know whether the chain was the reason — the owner was also retiring at the time. Still, the closure stands as a poignant testament to the shifting landscape of community commerce, serving as a reminder of what we stand to lose.

What the original says, in short:

• corner bookstore in the writer's neighborhood closed eight months after a chain store opened two blocks away

• writer says it is just one example

• writer does not know whether the chain was the reason

• the owner was also retiring

Rewrite X

> The corner bookstore in my neighborhood closed eight months after a chain store opened two blocks away.
>
> That's just one example, and I don't know whether the chain was the reason. The owner was also retiring at the time. Still, the closure is a sad reminder of what a community stands to lose as local shopping changes.

Rewrite Y

> The corner bookstore in my neighborhood closed eight months after a chain store opened two blocks away.
>
> That's one example, and I can't say the chain was the reason, since the owner was also retiring at the time. Still, the closure stays with me as a reminder of what a neighborhood can lose.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____

Item 23 · 23-academic-correlation

Original

> The relationship between physical activity and academic achievement has garnered significant attention in recent years. In the present study, the utilization of the campus gym was found to be associated with higher self-reported GPAs among students (r = 0.18, n = 212), highlighting the potential role of exercise in academic success. However, it is important to note that this correlation may reflect underlying differences in time management rather than the effects of exercise itself. Furthermore, the existing body of evidence regarding this relationship remains mixed, underscoring the need for further investigation.

What the original says, in short:

• students who used the campus gym more often reported higher GPAs

• correlation r = 0.18, n = 212

• the correlation may reflect time management rather than exercise

• prior evidence is mixed

Rewrite X

> The relationship between physical activity and academic achievement has drawn attention in recent years. In this study, students who used the campus gym reported higher GPAs (r = 0.18, n = 212), which suggests exercise may play a role in academic success. The correlation may instead reflect underlying differences in time management rather than an effect of exercise itself. Evidence on this relationship is also mixed, so it needs further investigation.

Rewrite Y

> Researchers have paid growing attention to the relationship between physical activity and academic achievement. In this study, students' use of the campus gym was associated with higher self-reported GPAs (r = 0.18, n = 212), which may point to a role for exercise in academic success. The correlation may, however, reflect underlying differences in time management rather than an effect of exercise itself. The existing evidence on this relationship is also mixed, and further investigation is needed.

Natural: X / Y / same **Faithful:** X / Y / same **Note:** _____